



Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Developer Survey

65,437 respondents • 180+ countries • 2024

Source: survey.stackoverflow.co/2024/work

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

69%

Full-Time Employment
(Global)

16.4%

Independent / Freelance
(Global)

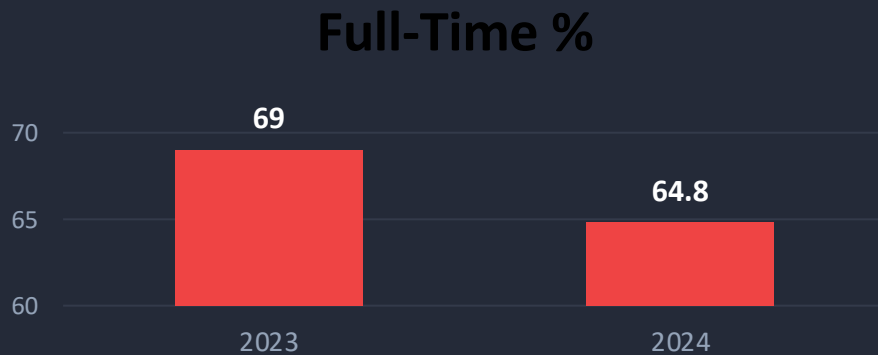
13.2%

Full-Time Students
(Global)

84%

Currently Working
(Any capacity)

U.S. Full-Time Employment Trend



Regional Patterns

U.K. & Ukraine:

Non-FT respondents lean toward independent contracting

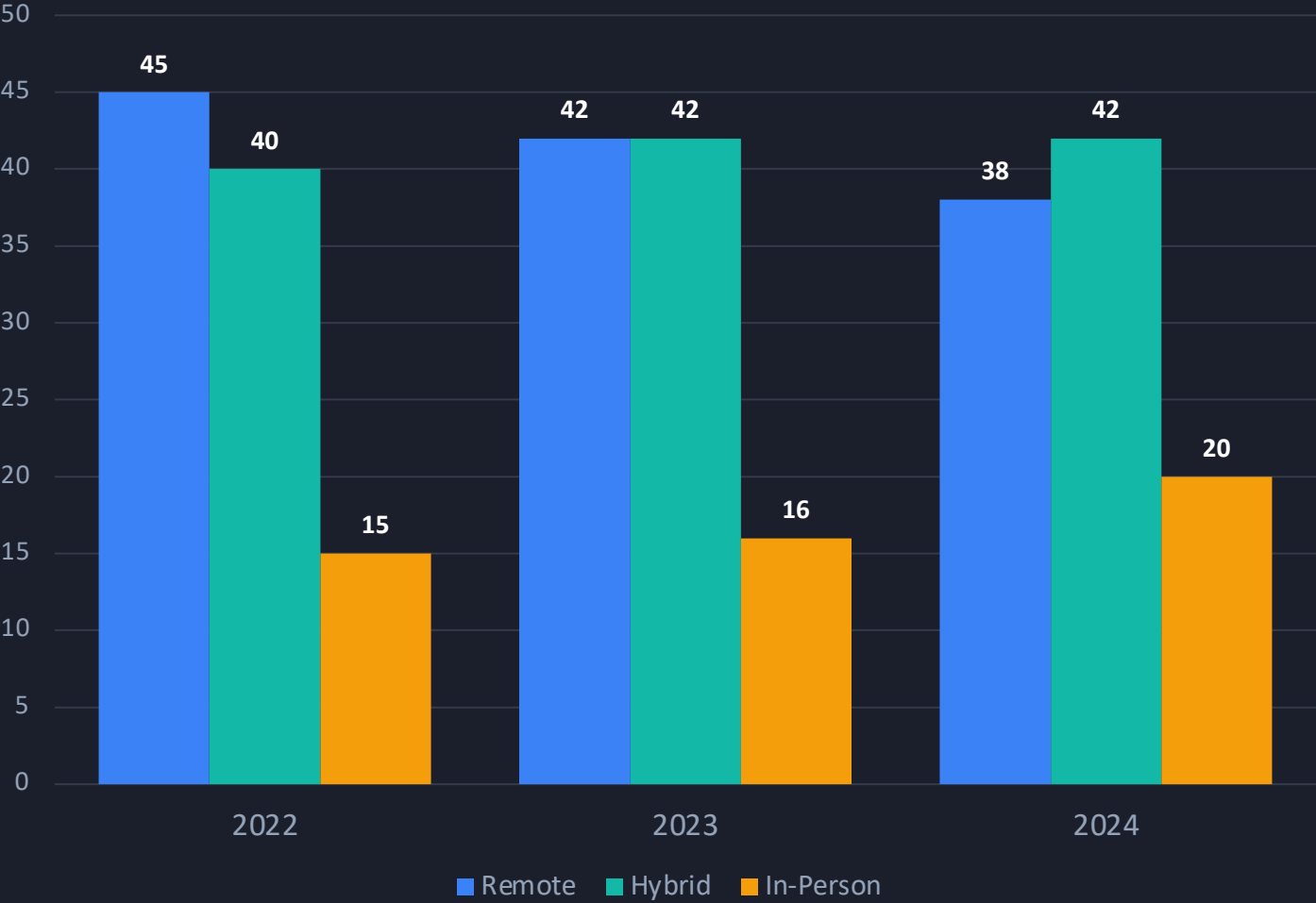
Germany & India:

Non-FT respondents are more likely to be full-time students

U.S. Drop:

Full-time fell 4.2 pp YoY
(69% → 64.8%)

In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%



Hybrid Dominates

42%

Consistent across
2023 and 2024

Remote Declining

38%

Down from 45%
in 2022

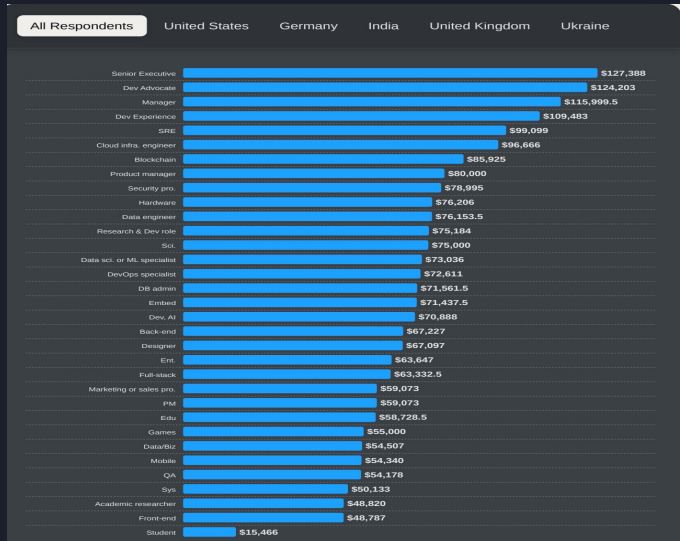
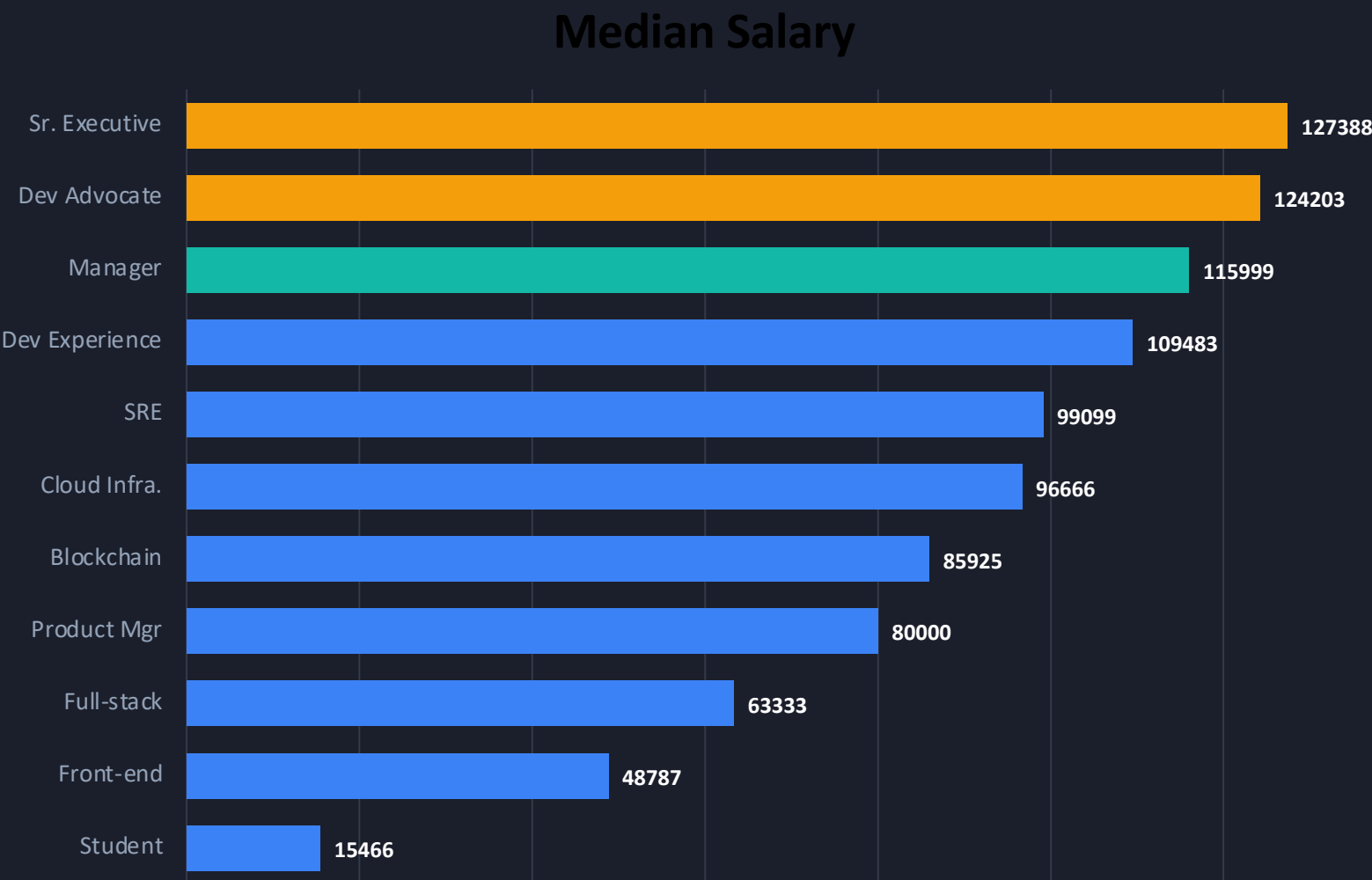
In-Person Rising

20%

Up from 15% in 2022
(3rd consecutive year)

Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary

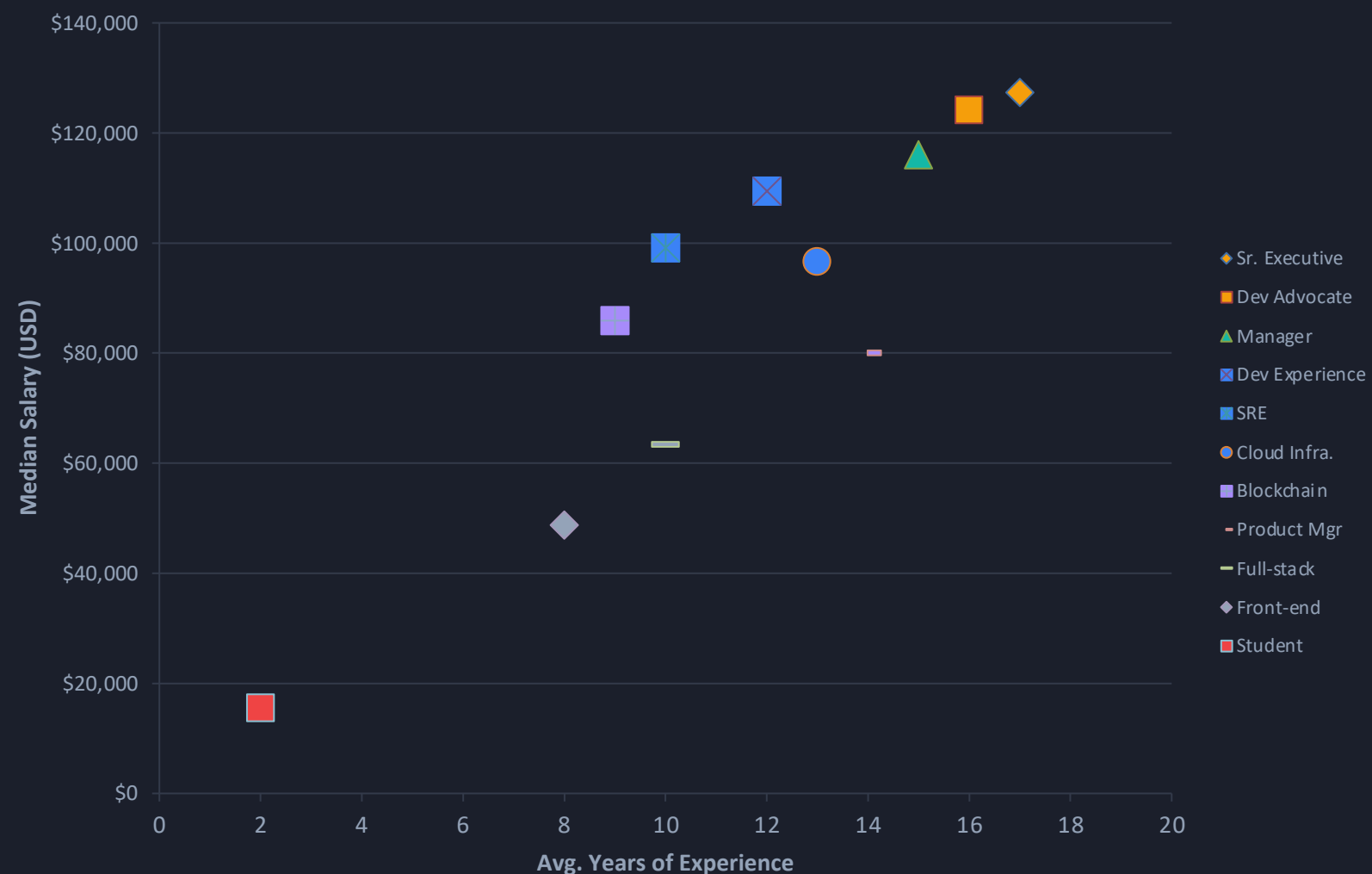
Median Annual Compensation (USD) — 22,677 salary responses



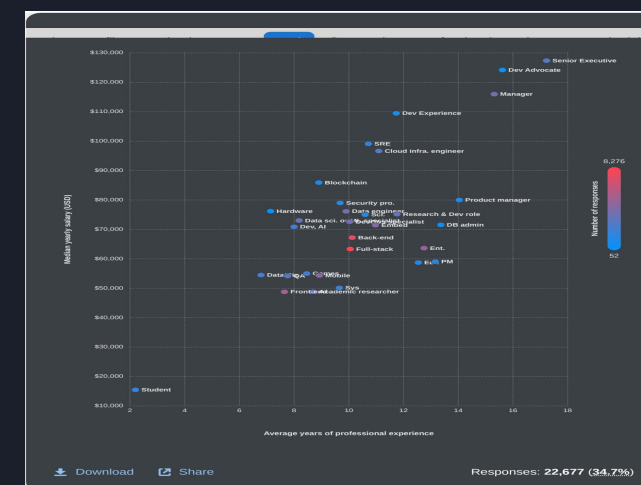
Key Insight

SRE and Cloud Infrastructure are the highest-paid purely technical roles, reflecting their critical importance in keeping digital services running.

Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries

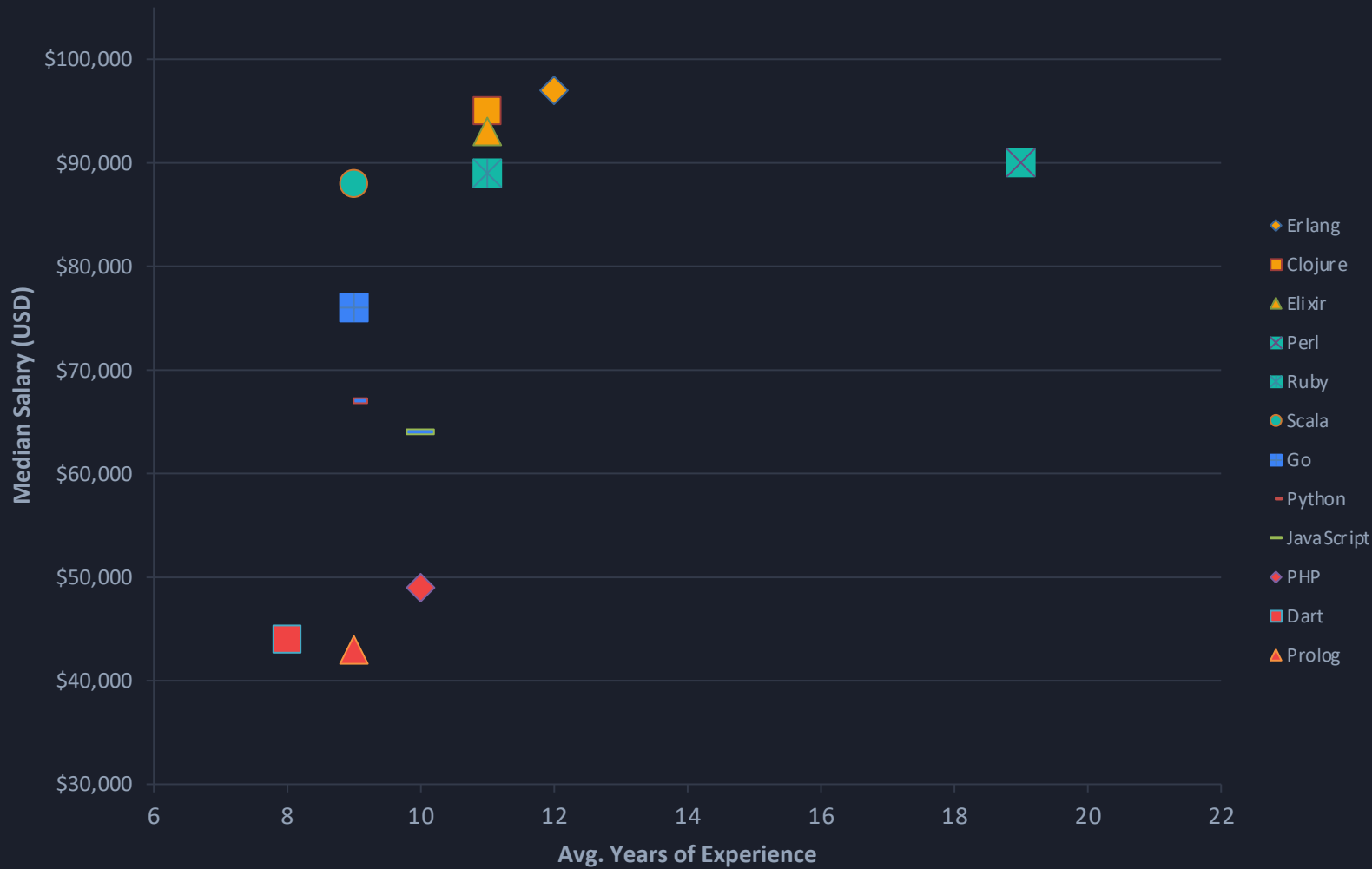


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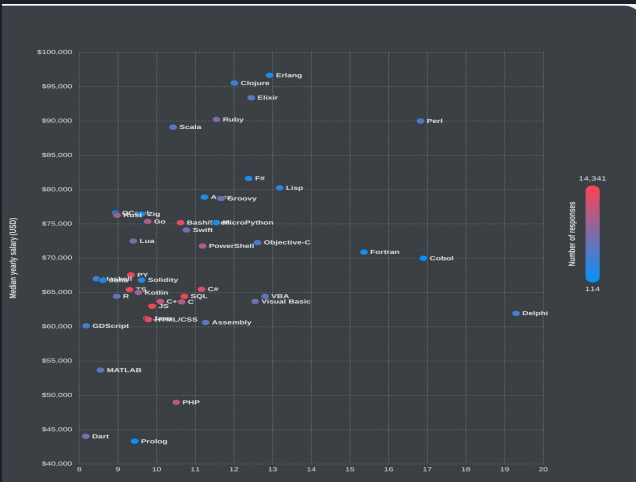


Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K

Overall reported salary range dropped ~\$10K vs. 2023 (now \$60–75K avg. vs. \$70–85K)

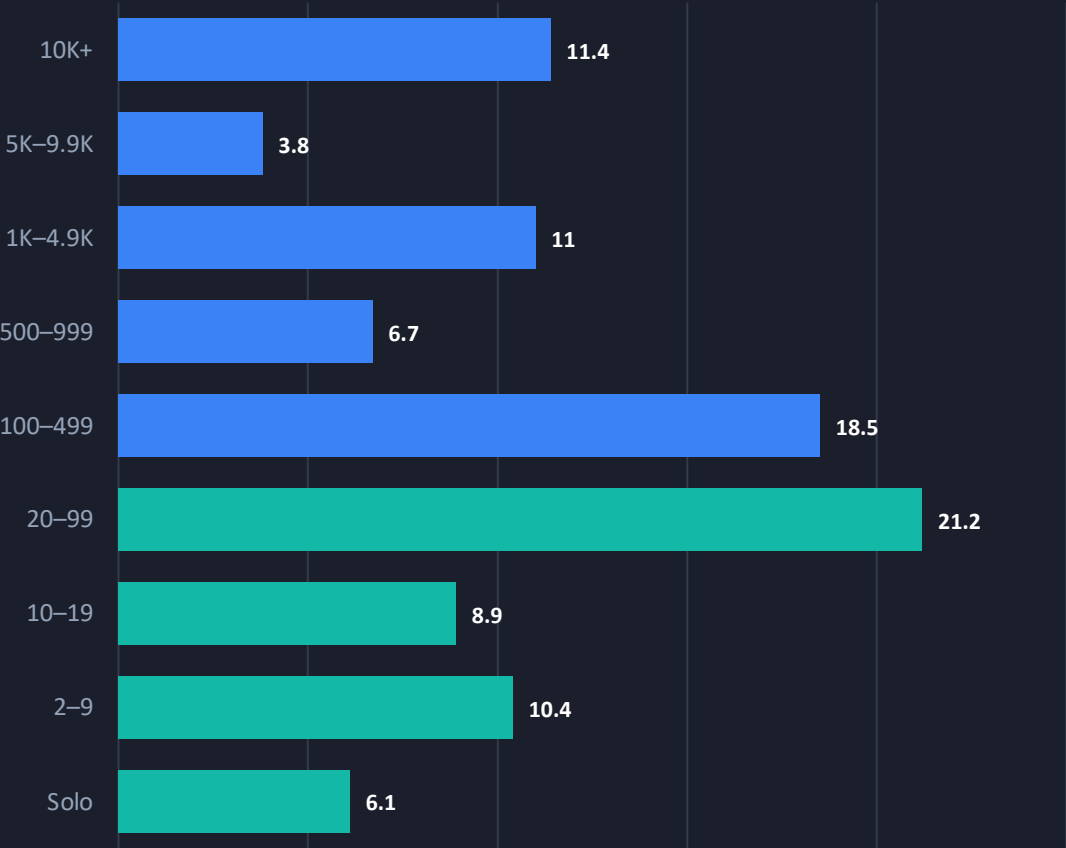


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47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

Share %



42,827 respondents • Teal bars = sub-100 employees (47%)

Technology Purchasing Influence

62%

Have influence over tech purchases

60%

Prefer build-and-buy approach

Purchase Influence by Role

Sr. Executives	99%
Engineering Managers	87%
Product Managers	77%

Top eval methods: Free trial (75%) • Ask developers (73%)

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

01

Plan for a Blended Workforce

U.S. full-time employment fell 4 pp YoY. Freelancing and contracting remain significant at 16%+. Build flexible engagement models alongside FTE headcount.

02

Respect Hybrid as the Default

Hybrid (42%) dominates, but in-person is climbing to 20%. RTO mandates risk attrition if not paired with clear value for on-site days.

03

Budget Premium Pay for DevRel & SRE

Dev Advocates (\$124K) and SREs (\$99K) command top-tier compensation. Under-budgeting these roles leads to costly attrition in critical functions.

04

Use Language & Stack as a Salary Signal

Niche functional languages (Erlang \$97K, Clojure \$95K) correlate with higher pay. Factor stack choices into compensation benchmarking, not just role titles.

05

Engage Developers in Purchasing Decisions

62% of developers influence tech purchases. Vendor strategies should target ICs via free trials (75%) and peer recommendations (73%), not just management.